

EYES WIDE OPEN

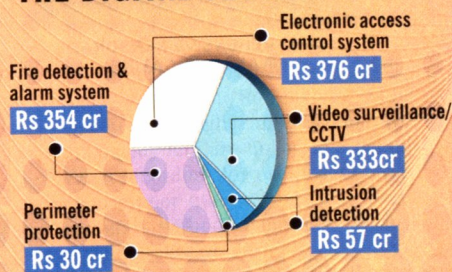


CAUGHT ON CAMERA

■ Chain snatchers grabbed a bag containing cash and an ATM card from a nurse at a Delhi hospital. They went on a shopping spree with the card but were caught and arrested, thanks to CCTV footage.

■ A couple teaching in a management school was arrested for stealing jewellery worth Rs 2 lakh from a showroom at a Delhi hotel. Police had analysed CCTV footage of them carrying out a theft at another showroom.

THE DIGITAL SECURITY PIE



Photograph: REUBEN SINGH. Graphics by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY

murder of British teenager Hannah Foster on fugitive Maninder Pal Singh Kohli. It was easy enough in a country which has over four million cameras and counting. The cameras also caught the four bombers behind the July 2005 London terror attacks, strolling with bomb-laden backpacks into the underground. The most well-known breakthrough in a terror attack also came from CCTVs in the US when recordings identified the 9/11 bombers at airports.

"The explosive development of infrastructure in the past five years—malls, airports, office complexes and call centres—are key growth drivers," says Iqbal Singh Jagdeva, president of the Asian Professional Security

Association. A Frost and Sullivan report on the Indian electronic security business estimates the Indian video surveillance and CCTV market to be worth Rs 333 crore. It forms about 29 per cent of the Rs 1,150-crore electronic security market in India, which is growing at 14 per cent per annum.

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) recommends CCTVs as standard fitment in most infrastructure facilities, including all the new airports under development in the country. The 79 pan-tilt-zoom CCTV cameras at Bangalore's new Devanahalli airport ensure that the seven agencies in the Airport Operations Control Centre have an uninterrupted view of the entire

airport from the airside area to the passenger facilities.

Also aiding the growth of the industry is the looming spectre of urban terror and a lengthening list of possible terror targets—from public transport systems to markets and places of worship. The Frost and Sullivan report outlines these growth-drivers (*see graphic, next page*). Terrorist attacks create an instant clamour for CCTV footage from the authorities. After the Delhi blasts of 2005 that left dozens dead, police installed over 300 street cameras in seven busy markets including Chandni Chowk, Karol Bagh and the tony Khan Market. Railway stations and interstate bus terminals